KCE PATHWAYS · GRADES 4–5 · UNIT 3: BUILDING THINGS · WEEK 12 · READING

Building Up Houston: Informative Writing, Paragraphs and Transitions

Name: _____ Date: _____

PRE-LESSON WARM-UP · DO THIS BEFORE YOUR COMPUTER LESSON

Pre-Lesson Warm-Up: Building a Paragraph

Before the lesson, show what you already know about how paragraphs are built. Do your best. It is fine to guess!

1. Which sentence would make the best TOPIC sentence for a paragraph about building on clay soil?

   Clay soil makes building a foundation tricky. | The crew eats lunch at noon. | My favorite color is brown.

2. Circle the transition word, then write its job (order, example, contrast, or effect): The rain lasted all day. As a result, the crew stayed home.

3. Cross out the sentence that does NOT belong: Cranes lift heavy loads. They can lift steel beams to the top floor. I like tacos. Some cranes are taller than the building.

4. Add the missing comma: Next the crew pours the concrete.

5. Review (Week 11): Which sentence is punctuated correctly?

   "Watch the crane," Andre said. | "Watch the crane." Andre said. | "Watch the crane", Andre said.

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POST-LESSON CHALLENGE · DO THIS AFTER YOUR COMPUTER LESSON

Post-Lesson Challenge: Paragraph Builder

Now use everything you practiced today: topic sentences, supporting details, transition words, and concluding sentences.

1. Write the letters in the best order to make a paragraph: A. Next, they tie steel bars into grids. B. Building the frame takes teamwork. C. Finally, concrete is poured around the steel. D. First, workers set up the forms.

2. Fill in each blank with the best transition (however, for example, as a result): Houston gets strong storms. _____, builders install thick windows. Many workers help. _____, electricians run wires. Concrete cracks when stretched. _____, steel is strong when stretched.

3. Find the off-topic sentence and write a better supporting detail to replace it: Inspectors keep buildings safe. They check the foundation. My uncle has a red truck. They test the wiring.

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POST-LESSON CHALLENGE · DO THIS AFTER YOUR COMPUTER LESSON · CONTINUED

Post-Lesson Challenge: Paragraph Builder

4 Rewrite with correct capitals and commas: first the crew in houston pours concrete. however the rain slows them down.

5 Writing: Write an informative paragraph (5 to 6 sentences) about a building, bridge, barn or other structure in your community. Include a topic sentence, at least three supporting details, at least two transition words, and a concluding sentence. Underline your topic sentence and circle your transitions.

★ **Challenge:** Write a two-paragraph informative piece about how something in your community is built or made (a house, a garden, a road, a quilt, or a meal). Give each paragraph its own topic sentence and main idea, use at least four different transition words, and end the second paragraph with a concluding sentence that wraps up both.

Looking Ahead: Week 13: Figurative language and poetry. You will explore similes, metaphors and personification in original poems set in a mountain village in Peru.